BOOK 1

VIOLIN BEGINNER GUIDE

Posture and Basic Bowing

Get to know the violin, build a relaxed hold and learn to bow the four open strings.

01 Know the parts and string order

02 Build a relaxed violin and bow hold

03 Bow evenly and change strings



Start with relaxed posture

READ IN ORDER

Next: Book 2 - Reading Music and Your First Melody.

Inside this book

Posture and Basic Bowing

03 **Parts and the four strings**

Learn names and the order from low to high.

04 **Violin hold and relaxed posture**

Standing posture, support and shoulder-rest checks.

05 **Bow hold and finger roles**

A curved thumb, flexible little finger and easy wrist.

06 **Left-hand shape and fingering**

A natural wrist, curved fingers and numbers 0-4.

07 **Bow path and contact area**

Frog, middle and tip; a straight, steady bow path.

08 **Open strings and first string changes**

Even strokes first, then neighboring strings.

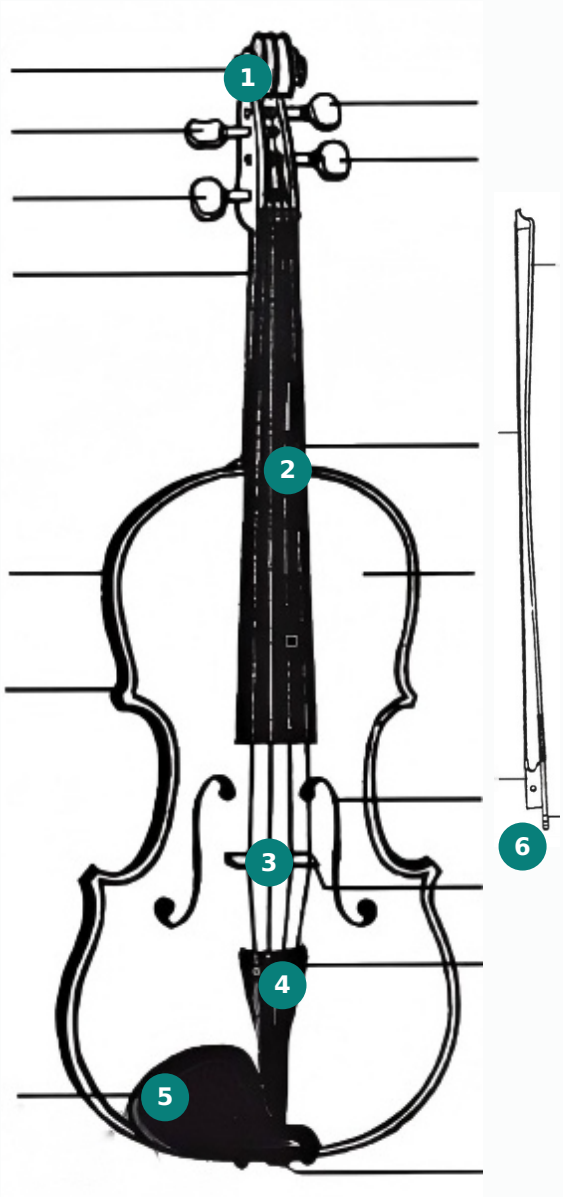
PRACTICE NOTES

Goal: support the violin naturally, keep a flexible bow hold, play an open string to a steady pulse and begin changing to a neighboring string.

Each book is numbered from its cover. Source notes retain the original textbook page numbers.

Know the parts and four strings

Learn these everyday names so the playing instructions are easy to follow.



1. **Scroll and tuning pegs**

   The pegs make larger tuning adjustments.

2. **Neck and fingerboard**

   Pressing a string changes its vibrating length.

3. **Bridge**

   Supports the strings and transfers vibration to the body.

4. **Tailpiece**

   Secures the lower ends of the strings.

5. **Chinrest**

   Supports the jaw and helps steady the violin.

6. **Bow**

   Stick, hair, frog and adjustment screw.

Low to high: G - D - A - E

G	D	A	E
4th / lowest	3rd string	2nd string	1st / highest

0 means an open string: bow the string without pressing it with the left hand.

Source: Original pp. 2, 6, 15.

Support the violin. Release tension.

Begin standing and use a mirror. Adjust the violin and shoulder rest to your build.



1. **Stand naturally**

   Feet about shoulder-width apart. Balance your weight and keep the knees easy.

2. **Rest the violin on the left collarbone**

   Place the jaw lightly on the chinrest. Avoid raising the shoulder or squeezing the neck.

3. **Point the scroll left and forward**

   Keep a comfortable height; avoid holding the violin too high, too low or too far toward the center.

4. **Set a comfortable shoulder-rest height**

   Adjust for your neck length so your head and neck can stay natural.

A 30-second check before playing

Shoulders can release

Lift and release them gently, then settle the violin again.

No forceful head tilt

Rest the jaw lightly. Keep breathing and head movement natural.

Room for the right arm

When seated, leave the arm room to bow; avoid leaning firmly into the chair back.

A gentle left-hand support

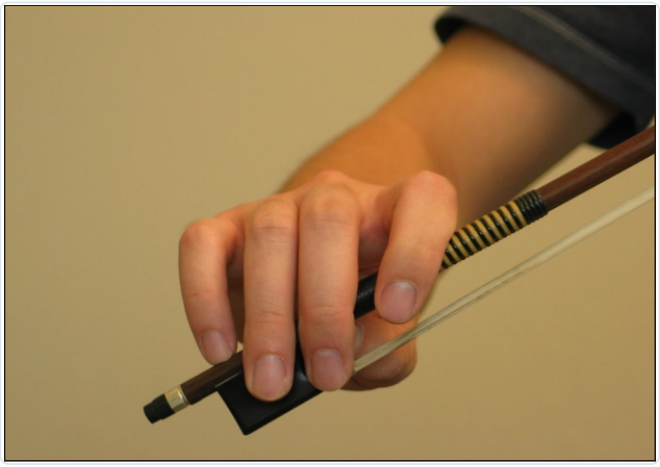
Let the thumb and index-finger base assist without gripping.

If tension builds, put the violin down, relax your shoulders and arms, then reset.

Source: Original pp. 10-11.

Flexible fingers, a balanced bow

Let your right hand hang naturally. Keep that relaxed curve as you pick up the bow.



Front: fingers naturally spaced



Back: avoid raised, rigid knuckles



Keep the thumb curved.
Avoid locking or pushing it straight.

1. **Thumb**

   Keep it curved against the underside of the stick for an elastic support.

2. **Middle and ring fingers**

   Let them rest naturally, forming a gentle ring with the thumb.

3. **Index finger**

   Rest it on the stick; let it help guide contact and weight.

4. **Little finger**

   Keep it curved and lightly balanced on top of the stick.

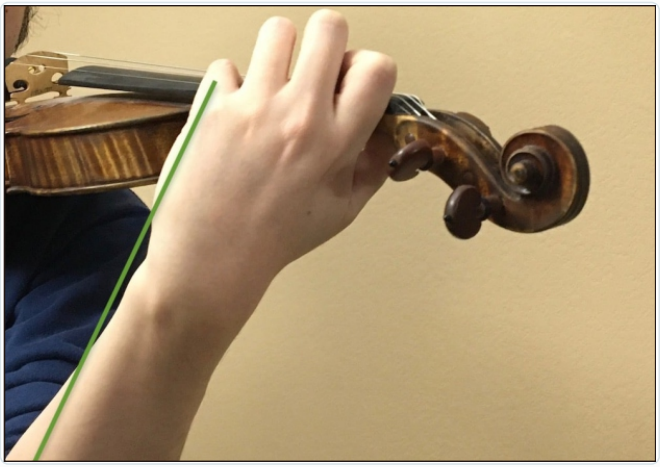
Practice card: pick up, release, repeat

Without bowing, form the hold five times. Check for a curved thumb and little finger, a relaxed wrist and lightly spaced fingers. Keep the grip gentle.

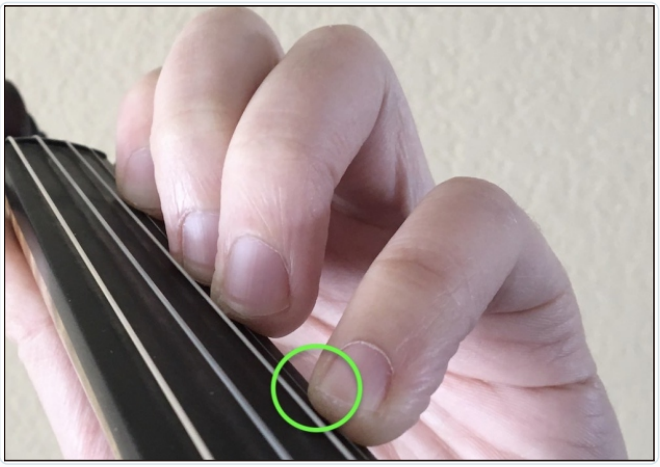
Source: Original pp. 12-13.

A natural wrist and curved fingers

Build the hand shape before adding speed. Use light, clear movements and curved joints.



Let the wrist follow the forearm



Use the fingertip; keep joints curved

1. **Let the thumb assist gently**

   Avoid pinching the neck between thumb and index-finger base. Leave space in the palm.

2. **Use the fingertip area**

   Keep a natural curve. Use enough pressure for a clear note without pressing harder than needed.

3. **Lift and place fingers clearly**

   Move from the base knuckles with small, definite actions. Keep the lifted fingers relaxed.

Reading fingering numbers

0	1	2	3	4
Open string	Index finger	Middle finger	Ring finger	Little finger

Check finger placement by listening. Visual spacing alone cannot confirm accurate pitch.

Source: Original pp. 13, 16-17.

Straight, level and steady

Keep the bow roughly parallel to the bridge. Let the right-arm joints work together.



Frog

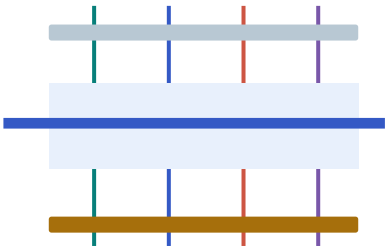


Middle



Tip

Find a useful contact area



Straight path; stable string level

Begin with short strokes at the middle of the bow. Avoid drifting toward the bridge or fingerboard. Adjust the arm level when changing strings to avoid catching a neighbor.

Steady speed and contact

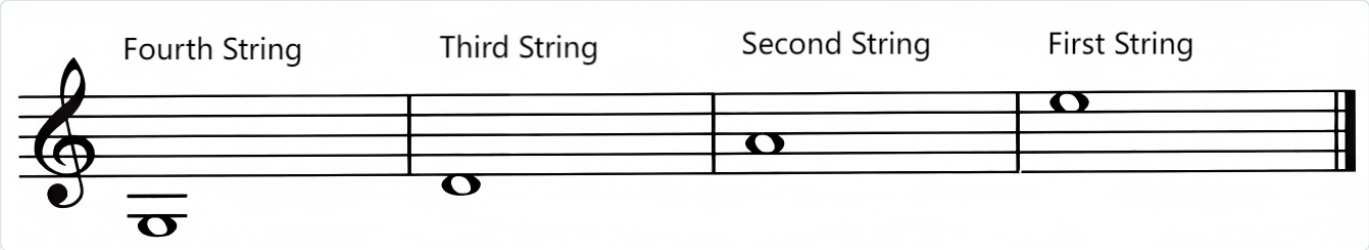
Keep bow speed and pressure even within each stroke. Allow the wrist and fingers to stay flexible at a bow change.

Source: Original pp. 11, 14-15.

Your first sounds: G, D, A and E

Leave out left-hand fingering for now. Focus on a balanced bow hold and an even sound.

G string / 0 | D string / 0 | A string / 0 | E string / 0



From left to right: fourth string G, third string D, second string A, first string E.

1. **Steady strokes on one string**

   Choose A or E. Use short middle-bow strokes, two beats per bow. Alternate down and up for eight strokes.

2. **Try neighboring strings**

   Work in G-D, D-A and A-E pairs. Bow each string for four beats. Pause to find the new level before sounding it.

3. **Connect all four strings**

   Play G-D-A-E, then return to G. Keep the same beat length as you change strings.

Suggested starting point: 60 bpm

The practice tempo is a suggestion. Choose a speed that allows relaxed movement and an even sound. Increase it a little only when the exercise is secure.

- [ ] Only the intended string sounds
- [ ] Up-bows and down-bows sound even

Source: Original pp. 6, 14-15; added beat counts.